PORTFOLIO CASE STUDY · RUPAK GHANPATHI · NOVEMBER 2026

Every short-paid rupee needs a reason, an owner and an ending

A working reconciliation desk for brands and lenders: classification rules, maker-checker controls, balanced ledger postings and 27 executable tests.

Live: everyrupee-o2c.vercel.app · Former Business Analyst, HDFC Bank (2.5 years)

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Unowned deductions tie up cash and, from 30 November, can turn a timing difference into a permanent GST cost

The problem

Distributors and borrowers pay short or bounce. The gap lands in receivables with no reason and no owner, and is chased by email or written off.

The decision

Control over speed. Rules explain the routine gaps; everything else gets one owner and a deadline. No rule writes money off; a second person approves above ₹10,000.

The proof

A working desk in two modes, 14 business rules, 27 tests that run in the browser, and a ledger that balances on every action.

Three things to look at in 60 seconds: the GST-window warning on an old claim, the control tower, and the lender desk refusing to re-present a closed account (NPCI code 01).

WHY NOW

Receivables at a listed FMCG brand grew faster than sales, and the rules for discounts changed on 1 November

+14.0% vs +8.8%

Cello World's trade receivables (₹658 → ₹750 Cr) against revenue (₹2,136 → ₹2,324 Cr), FY25 → FY26: about ₹34 Cr above revenue pace.
Annual reports · my estimate: a reason to look, not a diagnosis

₹3.5–5

Distributor margin per ₹100. Too thin to wait months for claims, so distributors deduct at payment.
AICPDF, via Outlook Business, Jun 2026

30 Nov

Last date to issue a GST credit note for FY 2025-26 supplies (CGST s.34(2)). After it, only a financial credit note: the GST stays paid.
Finance Act 2026 · CBIC Circular 251/08/2025 · summarised, not tax advice

APPROACH

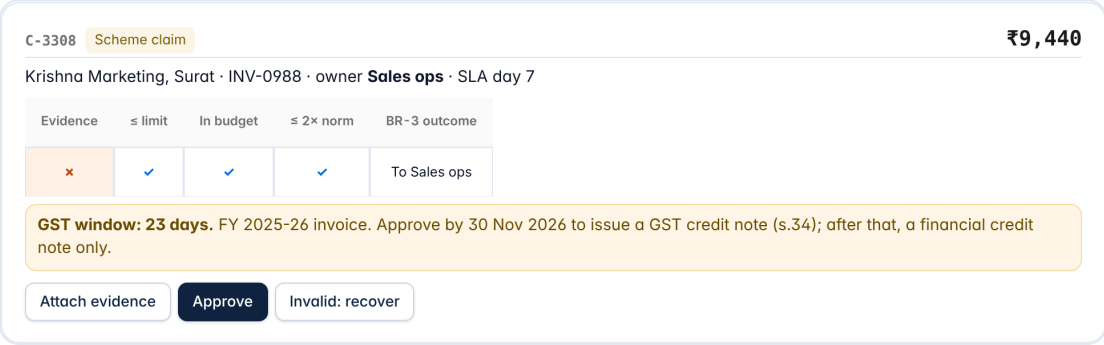
The same gap, two ways: today it lives in email; on the desk it has an owner, a deadline and a posting

	HOW IT OFTEN RUNS TODAY	ON THE DESK
Explained	Day 31, if ever	**Same day, by rule (BR-1 to BR-3)**
Owned	Email threads, no owner	**One case, one owner, one deadline; escalates on breach**
Approved	Whoever replies first	**Maker-checker above ₹10,000; self-approval blocked (BR-5)**
Closed	Silent write-off, or never	**GST or financial credit note, or recovery; never a rule write-off (BR-4, BR-6)**
Recorded	Rebuilt from inboxes	**Every action logged; every rupee posted as a balanced voucher (BR-9)**

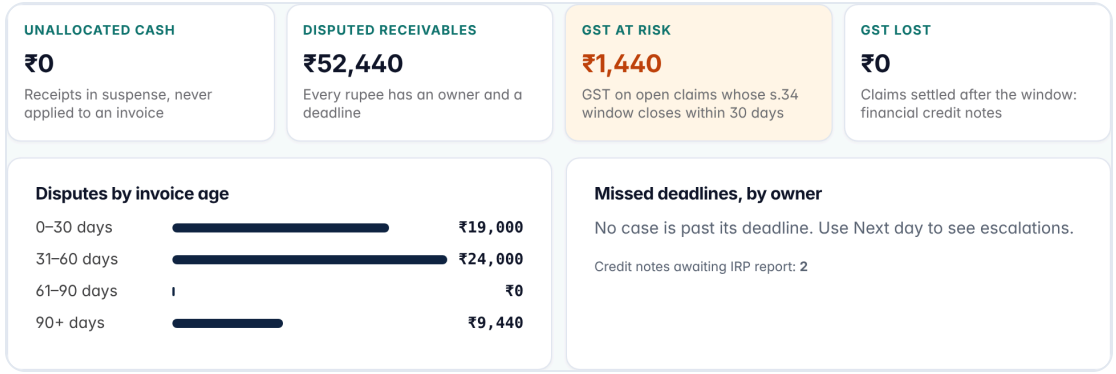
Illustrative: "today" is the common manual pattern, not a measured baseline.

THE PRODUCT · BRAND MODE

Every open claim shows its GST deadline, and the control tower shows what a finance head checks first



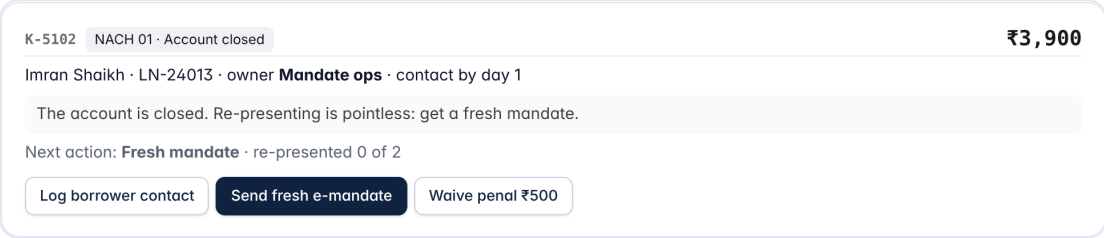
A ₹9,440 claim on a FY 2025-26 invoice: 23 days left to issue a GST credit note.



Unallocated cash, disputed receivables, GST at risk and GST lost; disputes by age and missed deadlines by owner.

THE PRODUCT · LENDER MODE

For a lender, the NPCI return code decides the next action, so no one re-presents a closed account



NACH return 01, account closed: re-presentation is blocked; a fresh mandate is requested.

- **04 / 68 / 59:** re-present, within the lender's limit. No penal charge when the bank's system failed (59).
- **01 / 02 / 14 / 61:** the mandate is dead. Get a fresh one.
- **06 / 17:** the borrower stopped it. Talk first; the penal charge waits.
- **Penal charges** kept separate, never earning interest (RBI, 18 Aug 2023).
- **Every overdue loan** has an owner and an RBI bucket: SMA-0, SMA-1, SMA-2.

GOVERNANCE

Every control traces from a public filing to a test that passes in the browser

FILING	ASSUMPTION	REQUIREMENT	RULE	TEST	SCREEN
Receivables +14.0% vs revenue +8.8% Cello World, FY26	**Short-payments sit unowned** A reason to look	**US-5: no self-approval above ₹10,000** In the BRD	**BR-5 maker-checker** Blocked, logged, routed	**UAT-06 passes** Maker approves own case	**Vikram approves** Finance controller

14

Business rules: 9 brand (BR-1 to BR-9), 5 lender (LR-1 to LR-5)

27 / 27

Tests passing, including the cases that must be blocked

0

Rules that can write money off. Every voucher balances.

TRADE-OFFS

Control has a cost, and I would rather name it than hide it

What this design costs

- Fewer auto-matches at launch: strict matching rejects fuzzy ones.
- More manual review: anything above ₹10,000 needs a second person.
- A slower first close: Sales must enter scheme dates and budgets first.

Where it could fail, and the answer

- Distributors pay the old account: keep it open a quarter; weekly list to Sales.
- Schemes change mid-quarter: no dates and budget, no valid scheme.
- Sales overrides the credit flag: it never blocks an order; overrides logged by name.

What I got wrong: v2 was a wall of text, so I rebuilt it as something you can run. A spec nobody executes isn't a spec.

ABOUT ME

Business Analyst who writes the rules, tests the controls and ships on time

25+

BRDs/FRDs at HDFC Bank on lending apps (APMS, InstaLoan)

15+

Releases 100% on time; 20+ UAT cycles, 95% of defects fixed before release

0

Findings across 4–5 SOX audits; RBI mandates delivered first

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Portfolio case study. Not affiliated with Cello World; no brand or lender uses it yet. Sample data. Tax and RBI rules summarised from public sources, Oct 2026; not legal or tax advice.